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Tutorial: Retrieve and Pass a Purchase Order Number to a Carrier

Use the Selling Partner API to retrieve and pass a purchase order number to UPS, FedEx, or USPS.

Business-to-business (B2B/Amazon Business) orders typically include purchase order (PO) numbers on shipping labels. Shipping labels that you retrieve through Seller Central or the Selling Partner API (SP-API) automatically include the PO number.

If you get shipping labels from a source outside of Amazon, the shipping labels might not include the PO number. For these cases, you can get the PO number by using the [Orders API](#) or the [Reports API](#) of the Selling Partner API. You then pass the PO number to the carrier when you use the carrier's API.

These tutorials show how to get the PO number and then pass the PO number to UPS, FedEx, and USPS.

What is an Amazon Business PO number?

An Amazon Business PO number is a unique identifier that a business customer assigns to the orders that they place on Amazon Business. The business customer enters the PO number at checkout.

Businesses can use the PO number for the following purposes:

- **Tracking and reference:** The PO number allows businesses to track and reference specific orders within their own procurement systems.
- **Billing and accounting:** The PO number helps associate purchases with the correct cost centers, departments, or projects.
- **Internal management:** Businesses can use the PO number to enforce internal purchasing policies, manage budgets, and ensure that orders comply with internal procurement procedures.
- **Communication:** Businesses can use the PO number in communications to Amazon Business or suppliers to reference and resolve order issues.

Tutorial: Retrieve a PO number by using the Orders API

The following tutorial shows how to retrieve a PO number by using the [Orders API](#).

Prerequisites

To complete this tutorial, you need:

- Authorization from the selling partner for whom you are making calls. For more information, refer to [Authorizing Selling Partner API applications](#).

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Tutorial: Retrieve and Pass a Purchase Order Number to a Carrier

• The following roles assigned to your developer profile and selected in the app registration page:

- The [Amazon Fulfillment](#) role.
- The [Buyer Communication](#) role.
- The [Buyer Solicitation](#) role.
- The [Finance and Accounting](#) role.
- The [Inventory and Order Tracking](#) role.
- The [Pricing](#) role.
- The [Product Listing](#) role.
- The [Professional Services \(Restricted\)](#) role.
- The [Selling Partner Insights](#) role.
- The [Direct to Consumer Shipping \(Restricted\)](#) role.
- The [Tax Invoicing \(Restricted\)](#) role.
- The [Tax Remittance \(Restricted\)](#) role.

Get all Amazon Business orders with PO number

Call the [searchOrders](#) operation. Ensure that the `includedData` parameter includes the `BUYER` value, along with any other desired data sets.

A successful response includes an `orders` array of one or more orders. A PO number is exclusive to Amazon Business orders, identifiable by the `AMAZON_BUSINESS` value in the `programs` response attribute. The PO number for an Amazon Business order can be accessed through the `buyer.buyerPurchaseOrderNumber` response attribute.

Get order details with PO number for an Amazon Business order

Call the [getOrder](#) operation ([Orders API v2026-01-01](#)) with the `orderId` of the Amazon Business order and include the `includedData` parameter with the `BUYER` value.

A successful response includes an `order` object, which contains information about the order. A PO number is exclusive to Amazon Business orders, identifiable by the `AMAZON_BUSINESS` value in the `programs` response attribute. The PO number for an Amazon Business order can be accessed through the `buyer.buyerPurchaseOrderNumber` response attribute.

Tutorial: Retrieve a PO number by using the Reports API

The following tutorial shows how to retrieve a PO number by using the [Reports API](#).

Step 1. Call the `createReport` operation

Call the [createReport](#) operation. Specify an [order report type](#).

Step 2. Check whether the report is finished

Periodically poll the Amazon SQS queue for the `REPORT_PROCESSING_FINISHED` event, which provides information when the report processing is `CANCELLED`, `DONE`, or `FATAL`. If report data is available, the event includes a value for the `reportDocumentId` field.

For details, refer to [Verify that Report Processing is Complete](#).

Step 3. Get the report

Note

- The `getReportDocument` operation is considered a restricted operation only when a restricted report type is specified.

- When calling the `createRestrictedDataToken` operation to get an RDT for the `getReportDocument` operation, the specified restricted resource can contain only a specific path, not a generic path.
- When using RDT to access the `getReportDocument` operation, make sure your application has the correct right roles to access the report. Refer to [Roles in the Selling Partner API](#) for roles to reports mapping.

Call the `getReportDocument` operation. Pass in the `reportDocumentId` value from the previous step.

A successful response includes a `url` that you can use to download the report. For details, refer to [Retrieve a Report](#).

Step 4. Download the report

Download the report from the URL that you found in the previous step.

Step 5. Check the `IsBusinessOrder` field

In the report, check if the `IsBusinessOrder` field is `true`. If the `IsBusinessOrder` field is `false` or is absent, the report doesn't include the PO number.

The following example shows a report that contains the `IsBusinessOrder` field set to `true`.

XML

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<AmazonEnvelope xmlns:xsi="http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema-instance"
xsi:noNamespaceSchemaLocation="amzn-envelope.xsd">
  <Header>
    <DocumentVersion>1.01</DocumentVersion>
    <MerchantIdentifier>A3912FIW0IVW91</MerchantIdentifier>
  </Header>
  <MessageType>OrderReport</MessageType>
  <Message>
    <MessageID>1</MessageID>
    <OrderReport>
      <AmazonOrderID>123-4567-8910</AmazonOrderID>
      <AmazonSessionID>12-13141516-171819</AmazonSessionID>
      <OrderDate>2024-03-18T16:59:49-07:00</OrderDate>
      <OrderPostedDate>2024-03-18T16:59:49-07:00</OrderPostedDate>
      <BillingData>
        <BuyerEmailAddress>7f032r5qjxxxxxx@marketplace.amazon.com</BuyerEmailAddress>
        <BuyerName>John Doe</BuyerName>
        <BuyerPhoneNumber>123-456-7891</BuyerPhoneNumber>
      </BillingData>
      <FulfillmentData>
        <FulfillmentMethod>Ship</FulfillmentMethod>
        <FulfillmentServiceLevel>Standard</FulfillmentServiceLevel>
        <Address>
          <Name>Denise Park</Name>
          <AddressFieldOne>1 Main Street</AddressFieldOne>
          <City>Bellevue</City>
          <StateOrRegion>WI</StateOrRegion>
          <PostalCode>53189-6553</PostalCode>
          <CountryCode>US</CountryCode>
          <PhoneNumber>+1 123-456-7891</PhoneNumber>
        </Address>
      </FulfillmentData>
      <IsBusinessOrder>true</IsBusinessOrder>
      <PurchaseOrderNumber>P012345</PurchaseOrderNumber>
      <Item>
        <AmazonOrderItemCode>123456789</AmazonOrderItemCode>
        <SKU>12-3456-789</SKU>
      </Item>
    </OrderReport>
  </Message>
</AmazonEnvelope>
```

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Amazon Selling Partner API Guard Implementation Guide [➤](#)

Tutorial: Retrieve and Pass a Purchase Order Number to a Carrier

```
<Title>Marshmallows</Title>
<Quantity>2</Quantity>
<ProductTaxCode>A1_FB_CANDY17</ProductTaxCode>
<ItemPrice>
  <Component>
    <Type>Principal</Type>
    <Amount currency="USD">20.90</Amount>
  </Component>
  <Component>
    <Type>Shipping</Type>
    <Amount currency="USD">0.00</Amount>
  </Component>
  <Component>
    <Type>Tax</Type>
    <Amount currency="USD">1.04</Amount>
  </Component>
  <Component>
    <Type>ShippingTax</Type>
    <Amount currency="USD">0.00</Amount>
  </Component>
</ItemPrice>
<ItemFees>
  <Fee>
    <Type>Commission</Type>
    <Amount currency="USD">-1.68</Amount>
  </Fee>
</ItemFees>
```

Step 6. Get the PO number

In the report, the PO number is in the `PurchaseOrderNumber` field. Refer to the previous step for an example response payload.

Tutorial: Pass a PO number to UPS

```
</OrderReport>
<!-- Important
```

The following tutorial relates to third-party API usage. Amazon does not endorse or control any of these third-party APIs. Engage with these third-party APIs at your own discretion.

The following tutorial shows you how to pass the PO number to UPS with the UPS [Shipment](#) operation.

Call the UPS [Shipment](#) operation

Call the UPS [Shipment](#) operation. In the `ReferenceNumber` array, set `Code` to `P0` and `Value` to the PO number.

There's a maximum of five package-level reference numbers allowed per shipment and only the first two reference numbers are printed on the label.

The following request example contains the payload for the [Shipment](#) operation:

JSON

```
{
  "ShipmentRequest": {
    "Shipment": {
      "Package": [
        {
          "ReferenceNumber": [
            {
              "Code": "P0",
              "Value": "CustomerPONum"
            }
          ]
        }
      ],
    }
  }
}
```

```
}  
}
```

For more information, refer to the following:

- [UPS Shipping Package API Documentation](#)
- [UPS Shipping Package API Schema](#)
- [UPS Reference Codes Documentation](#)

Tutorial: Pass a PO number to FedEx

Important

The following tutorial relates to third-party API usage. Amazon does not endorse or control any of these third-party APIs. Engage with these third-party APIs at your own discretion.

The following tutorial shows you how to pass the PO number to FedEx with the FedEx [CreateShipment](#) operation.

Call the FedEx `CreateShipment` operation

Call the FedEx `CreateShipment` operation. In the `requestedShipment` object, in the `requestedPackageLineItems.customerReferences` element, set `customerReferenceType` to `P_0_NUMBER` and `value` to the PO number. For a list of customer reference types, refer to [Customer Reference Types](#).

The following request example contains the payload for the [CreateShipment](#) operation:

JSON

```
{  
  "mergeLabelDocOption": "LABELS_AND_DOCS",  
  "labelResponseOptions": "LABEL",  
  "requestedShipment": {  
    "shipDatestamp": "2019-10-14",  
    "totalDeclaredValue": {},  
    "shipper": {},  
    "soldTo": {},  
    "recipients": [],  
    "recipientLocationNumber": "1234567",  
    "pickupType": "USE_SCHEDULED_PICKUP",  
    "serviceType": "PRIORITY_OVERNIGHT",  
    "packagingType": "YOUR_PACKAGING",  
    "totalWeight": 20.6,  
    "origin": {},  
    "shippingChargesPayment": {},  
    "shipmentSpecialServices": {},  
    "emailNotificationDetail": {},  
    "expressFreightDetail": {},  
    "variableHandlingChargeDetail": {},  
    "customsClearanceDetail": {},  
    "smartPostInfoDetail": {},  
    "blockInsightVisibility": true,  
    "labelSpecification": {},  
    "shippingDocumentSpecification": {},  
    "rateRequestType": [],  
    "preferredCurrency": "USD",  
    "totalPackageCount": 25,  
    "masterTrackingId": {},  
    "requestedPackageLineItems": [  
      {  
        "sequenceNumber": "1",  
        "subPackagingType": "BUCKET",  

```

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Delivery by Amazon API

EASY SHIP API

Easy Ship API

Tutorial: Retrieve and Pass a Purchase Order Number to a Carrier

```
"customerReferences": [
  {
    "customerReferenceType": "P_0_NUMBER",
    "value": "23456764"
  }
]
```

For more information, refer to the following:

- [FedEx Ship API Documentation](#)
- [FedEx Customer Reference Types](#)

Tutorial: Pass a PO number to USPS

 Important

The following tutorial relates to third-party API usage. Amazon does not endorse or control any of these third-party APIs. Engage with these third-party APIs at your own discretion.

The following tutorial shows you how to pass the PO number to USPS with the USPS [eVS Label](#) API.

Call the USPS [eVS Label](#) API

Call the USPS [eVS Label](#) API. Set the `CustomerRefNo` field or the `CustomerRefNo2` field to the PO number. To print the PO number on the label, set the `PrintCustomerRefNo` field to `true`.

The following request example uses the `CustomerRefNo` and `PrintCustomerRefNo` fields:

```
XML
<eVSRequest USERID="XXXXXX" PASSWORD="XXXXXX">
  <CustomerRefNo>PO: CustomerPONum</CustomerRefNo>
  <PrintCustomerRefNo>true</PrintCustomerRefNo>
</eVSRequest>
```

For more information, refer to the [USPS eVS Label Documentation](#).

Tutorial: Pass a PO number to Auctane

 Important

The following tutorial relates to third-party API usage. Amazon does not endorse or control any of these third-party APIs. Engage with these third-party APIs at your own discretion.

The following tutorial shows you how to pass the PO number to Auctane with the Stamps.com [CreateIndicium](#) operation.

Call the Stamps.com [CreateIndicium](#) operation

Call the Stamps.com [CreateIndicium](#) operation. Set the `memo` field to the PO number.

XML

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Finances API



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FULFILLMENT INBOUND API

Fulfillment Inbound API



Tutorial: Retrieve and Pass a Purchase Order Number to a Carrier

```
<CreateIndicium
xmlns="http://stamps.com/xml/namespace/2023/07/swsim/SwsimV135">
<memo>PO: CustomerPONum</memo>
</CreateIndicium>
```

For more information, refer to the [Stamps.com CreateIndicium Documentation](#).

Tutorial: Pass a PO number with EasyPost



Important

The following tutorial relates to third-party API usage. Amazon does not endorse or control any of these third-party APIs. Engage with these third-party APIs at your own discretion.

The following tutorial shows you how to pass the PO number with the EasyPost [Shipments](#) operation.

Call the EasyPost [Shipments](#) operation

Call the EasyPost [Shipments](#) operation. Set the `print_custom_1` field to the PO number. Set the `print_custom_1_code` field to the value `P0`.

JSON

```
"options": {
  "print_custom_1": "Custom label message",
  "print_custom_1_code": "P0"
}
```

For more information, refer to the [EasyPost Create a Shipment Documentation](#).

Updated 18 days ago

↗ Tutorial: Grant the SP-API
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Troubleshoot SP-API Errors →

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